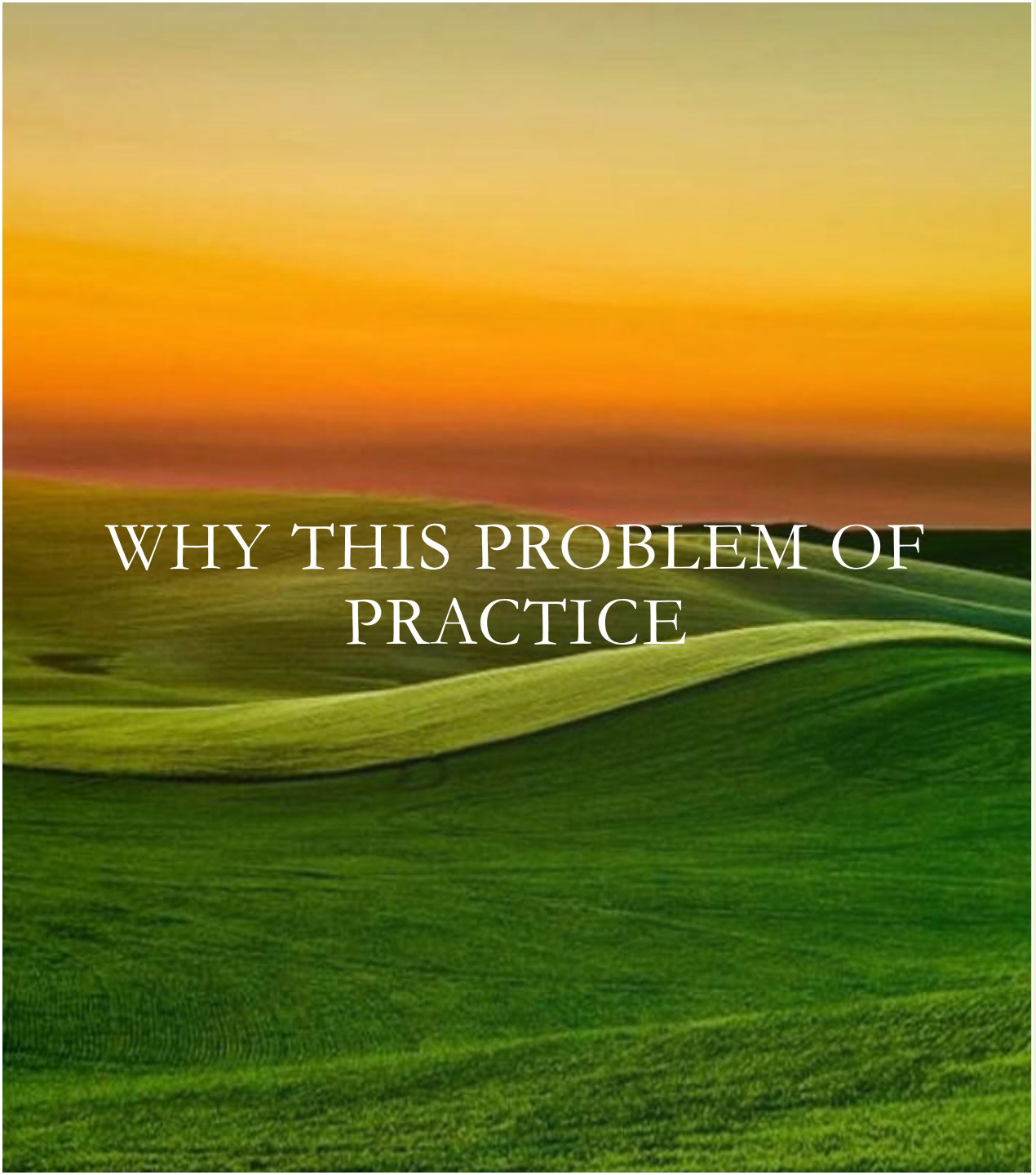
LEADING WELL

A LEADERSHIP LEARNING INTERVENTION - STEP STUDENT LEADERS & THE RELATIONAL LEADERSHIP MODEL

Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

- As a result of participating in the program, STEP student leaders will demonstrate the ability to identify at least three personal signs of burnout and imbalance within their leadership and peer-support roles.
- STEP student leaders will demonstrate understanding and application of the five components of the Relational Leadership Model (RLM) by integrating principles of balance, collaboration, and well-being into leadership scenarios and activities.
- STEP student leaders will demonstrate commitment to sustainable leadership by developing and articulating at least two relational leadership practices, such as boundary-setting and reflection.



WHY THIS PROBLEM OF PRACTICE

- Burnout is common among student leaders
- Emotional labor and high expectations
- Affects motivation, confidence, and belonging
- Need for sustainable, people-centered leadership

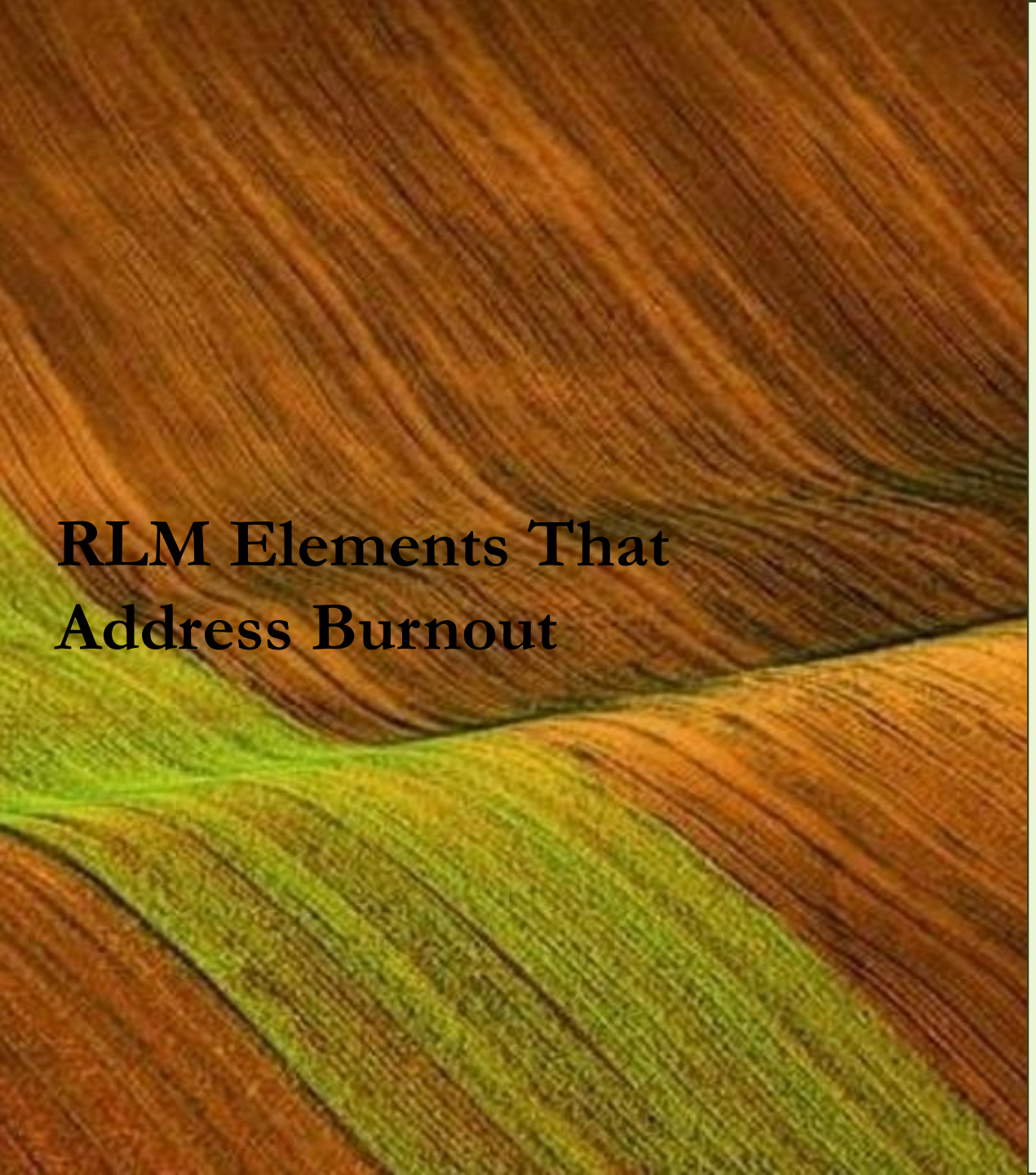
Why the Relational Leadership Model (RLM)?

Focus on relationships and wellbeing

Supports inclusive, ethical, and empowering leadership

Helps leaders reconnect to purpose

Encourages healthy leadership habits



RLM Elements That Address Burnout

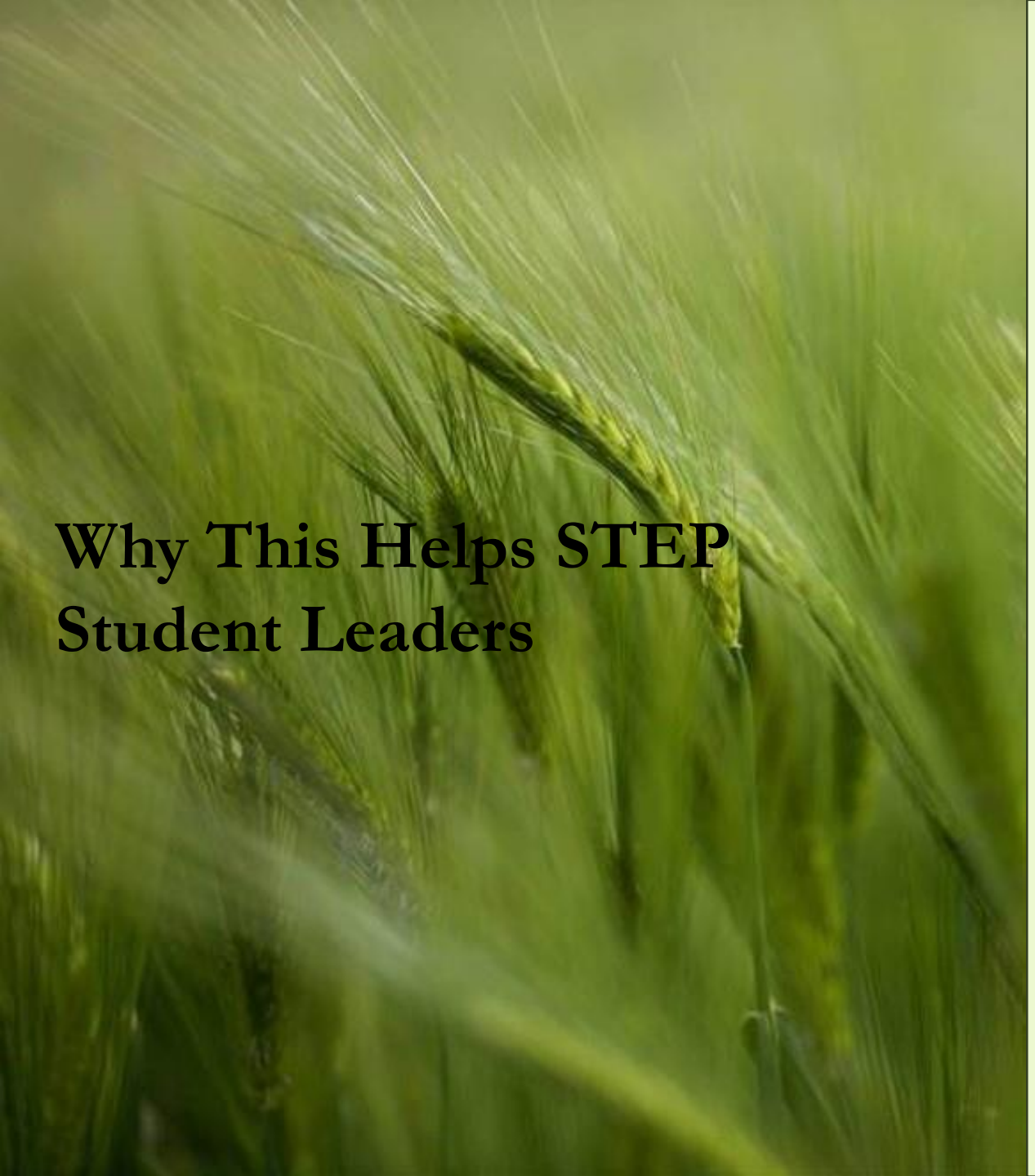
Purposeful: reconnect to why

Inclusive: reduce isolation, build community

Empowering: share workload, set boundaries

Ethical: self-care as responsibility

Process-oriented: reflect and adjust behaviors



Why This Helps STEP Student Leaders

Supports emotional well-being

Builds confidence and community

Encourages healthy boundaries

Offers practical strategies for sustained leadership

Learning Strategies & Pedagogies

- Experiential learning
- Reflective dialogue
- Collaborative learning
- Storytelling and shared experiences

Session	Focus	Key Goals	Time
Session 1: Recognizing Burnout & Understanding Relational Leadership	Define burnout; explore RLM as a wellness framework	Identify personal stress signals; connect leadership and wellbeing	90 min
Session 2: Empathy, Empowerment, and Boundaries in Leadership	Learn how inclusion and empowerment reduce burnout	Practice empathy and boundary-setting as tools for sustainability	90 min
Session 3: Leading with Purpose and Process	Integrate RLM principles into daily leadership	Create a personal Relational Wellness Action Plan.	90 min

Expected Impact

- Stronger self-awareness
- Improved balance and boundaries
- More relational, sustainable leadership
- Increased peer support and connection

Sustainability	Integrate the intervention into the existing STEP training cycle Engage returning STEP leaders as co-facilitators Implement mid-semester wellness check-ins and follow-ups

Thank you